

Balakrishnan to head virtualisation in Red Hat



Red Hat has announced that it has appointed a new head for its virtualisation technologies and solutions. Radhesh Balakrishnan will serve as the global leader of Red Hat's virtualisation infrastructure solutions, including responsibilities for the company's Red Hat OpenStack and Red Hat Enterprise virtualisation technologies and solutions.

Balakrishnan joins Red Hat from Microsoft, where he held product management and marketing responsibilities across a wide range of product lines.

"Radhesh and his team will continue to drive open virtualisation forward through our Red Hat Enterprise virtualisation and Red Hat OpenStack technologies and solutions – both of which are central to Red Hat's open hybrid approach to the cloud. We welcome Radhesh to the Red Hat team," said Paul Cormier, president, Products and Technologies, Red Hat.

Sailfish OS SDK released for Linux

Jolla, the developer of the Sailfish OS, has released the first SDK for the operating system. The launch timeframe for the SDK was delayed, well past its original schedule. Jolla has apparently created the SDK for developers using 32-bit and 64-bit Linux, for Windows and for Mac users.

The company says the SDK has been designed with the most recent consumer needs in mind, enabling "effortless multi-tasking" bringing "usability and speed-of-use to a totally new level, unseen in the mobile industry."

The event organiser, however, denied Stallman's request by saying that it doesn't want to restrict user's freedom of choice. Stallman, evidently, got miffed by the response and sent an e-mail to all those on the mailing list of the organisation.

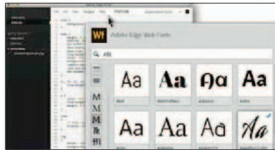
Three new Linux certifications on a platter!

With Linux growing at a fast pace, the demand for Linux certifications is also on the rise. Paul Paulito, a leading provider of online IT training courses focused on open source technologies, addresses this demand. The training provider has announced the availability of three new Linux certifications—Linux Basics, Linux Technician 1 and Linux Technician 2, which will be available from May.

The certifications are being offered at an affordable price, claims the company. The Linux Basics certification is intended for the academic sector, the youth and others new to the world of Linux and open source technologies. It is also useful for IT professionals looking to earn an entry-level Linux operating system certification. The Linux Technician 1 and Linux Technician 2 certifications are suited for IT professionals and for those looking to earn a first-class Linux certification.

An open source font that you can't see!

Adobe has announced the launch of Adobe Blank, which is an open source font that cannot be seen. The creator, Ken Lunde, mentioned in an official blog post that the need for a special purpose font came up when a few development teams asked the Adobe



Type Team to produce a font that had all Unicode code points covered, and where all code points are rendered using a non-spacing and non-marking glyph.

The team soon realised that Adobe-Identity-0 ROS was the right platform for

developing such a font. The two major purposes of this font, according to developer Joel Brandt, are:

- Invoking this font, as a temporary measure, prevents OS- or application-level font-fallback from kicking in before the intended font can be rendered. Related to this, using the font allows one to detect when a Web font is actually loaded, which is arguably a hack to overcome a limitation in CSS.

- The second purpose is to include Adobe Blank as a data URI in the CSS file. One example would be an element that is absolutely positioned off-screen. Check the width of the DOM element. If it's zero, SomeWebFont hasn't loaded yet. If it's greater than zero, it has.

An example of a real-world use for Adobe Blank is the Adobe Edge Web Fonts extension for Brackets, which is available on GitHub.

Those who are interested can download the font from SourceForge and it will soon be on GitHub too.

An Android-based OS from China

It seems that the mobile OS war is all set to heat up again. As speculations are rife over the arrival of Mozilla's Firefox mobile platform, Jolla's Sailfish OS and even Samsung's own Tizen OS for smartphones, here is another mobile OS, Smartisan from China, which is generating a lot of buzz these days. The brain behind the OS is Luo Yonghao, who is a self-taught ex-English teacher.